

Community Library Website: User Guide

The University of British Columbia

COSC 360 – Web Programming

Team 18

Authors' Note

This guide was prepared as part of the COSC 360 Final Project. It is intended for community members and general users of the Community Library, regardless of technical background. It walks through the core features of the application, including listing books, borrowing books, editing your profile, and other administrator functions. No prior technical knowledge is required.

Vision

The Community Library project is a website designed to facilitate book sharing within our community.

The application allows users to list books, borrow books, and engage in discussions through a chat system. The vision of the project is to create a seamless and free platform for community members to share books and foster cultural development through reading. Ultimately, we do not wish to become a book marketplace; our goal is to reduce waste while promoting reading experiences in an accessible way for a vibrant and collaborative community.

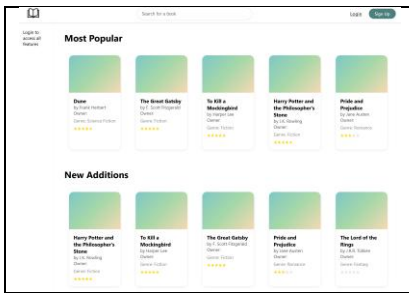
GitHub Link

<https://github.com/yta3216/CommunityLibrary.git>

Users

[Username; Password], [wong; wong11]; [hong; hong123]; [samuell; samuell]; [admin;admin]

Home Page for Unregistered Users.



The unregistered home page is where all new users will start their journey on our platform. Here they have very limited functionality, only being able to see the books available but not able to do anything besides that.

The goal of this page is to show users what they could access by registering and to prompt them to do so by clicking the button on the sidebar on the left or the button in the top right corner.

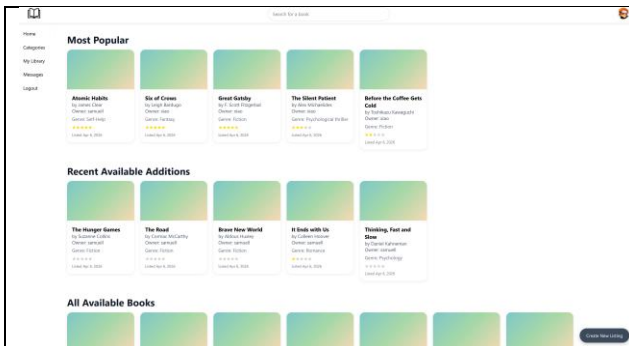
Register and Login.

Login and register follow a similar layout; however, they hold powerful validation mechanisms on all layers of our website.

Users cannot have repeated emails or usernames, you must add an image as part of your profile, passwords are expected to have more than 5 characters, and the “are you a robot” button needs to be checked in order to log in, providing a simple yet meaningful gesture that reflects our commitment to a human-only platform. Users can later edit most of this information on their profile page.

Overall, these two are simple yet essential parts of our website that represent the gates to our Community Library.

Home page for Registered Users.



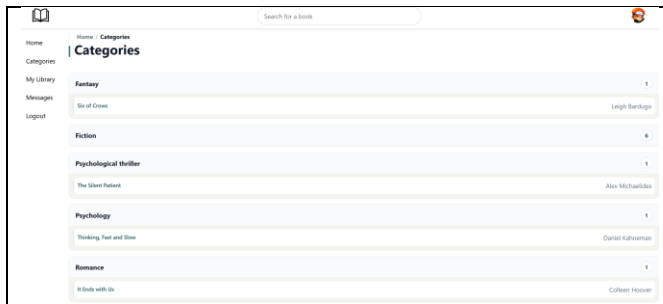
Here is the core of our platform. Users can search for books, browse them, check the most popular, and access pretty much all other features of the website.

The goal was to create a centralized gateway to all parts of the platform; not only did it need to be functionally good, but it also needed to be aesthetically pleasing and simple, all of which we believe we have achieved with this home page design.

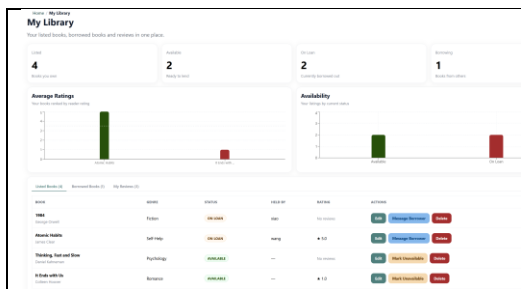
Creating a Listing.

By pressing the ‘Create New Listing’ button on the registered home page, a pop-up will appear prompting the user to enter the information regarding the book they wish to list. All information is required, since these are core aspects of our website’s functionality.

Users are expected to provide as much information as possible when making a listing so that other users can research and understand the available books. All books are automatically owned (immutably) and held by the listing creator. Users can delete listings from their ‘My Library’ page.

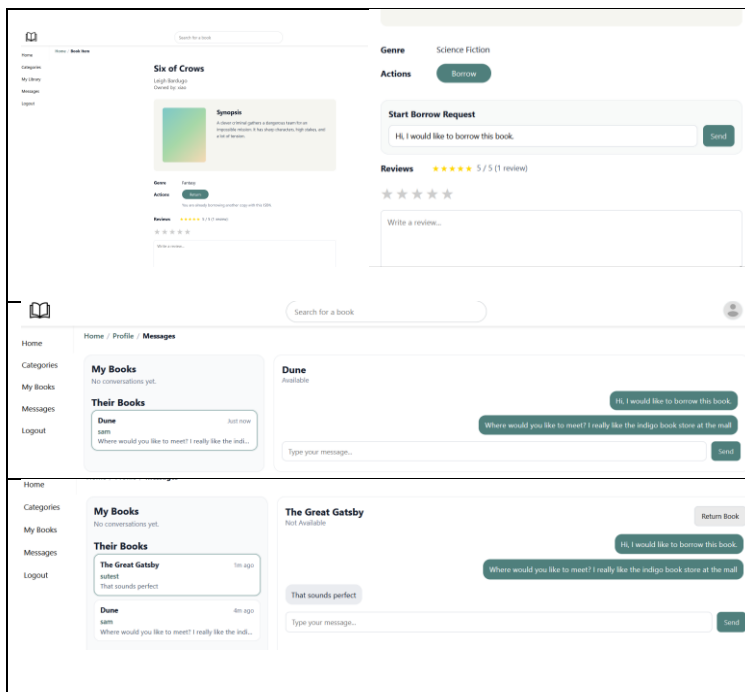
Categories.

The 'Categories Page' displays, in alphabetical order, the categories of added books. The goal is that through these collapsible items the user can easily find the books available in their favorite genre. Genres are listed based on the inputs that users provide when creating a listing, and any numeric or oddly formatted genres can be easily found under 'Others'.

My Library.

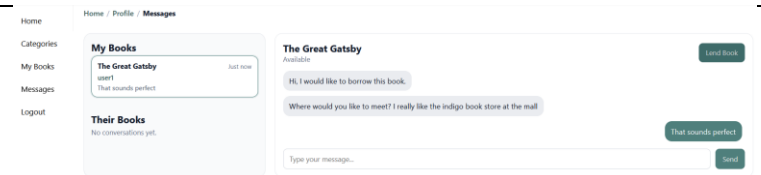
The 'My Library' page is the user's control center for all of their books. Here, a user can see who holds their books, manage their books, and check all the key numbers relevant to their activity on the website.

The goal of this page was to provide an admin-like experience that allows a user to manage their own matters within our Community Library.

Borrowing/Returning a Book.

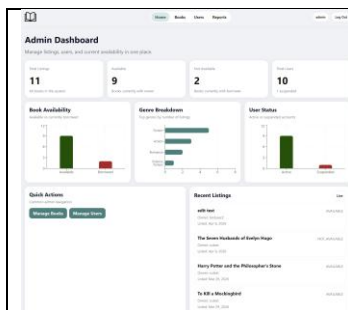
After choosing and clicking the book you wish to borrow, you will see a book page where you can read the book's information, check reviews, leave a review (which powers the most popular books list), and, most importantly, start a borrow request.

Borrow requests will start a conversation with the book owner where you can arrange the details of your borrowing.



After this dialog, the owner has the option of lending the book, and then the borrower gets the option of returning it. This will then change the holder of the book in our database, marking it as unavailable on the platform.¹

1 - If owner = holder, then the book is available; if owner != holder, then the book is not available. This logic is reinforced in our schema.

Administrative Functionalities.

By logging in as an admin, the user will be redirected to our admin dashboard, which shows our website's key numbers in a digestible and easy-to-comprehend way. The idea here is that the admin will be able to understand the general state of the platform at a glance.

From this page, the admin has five options: logging out in the top right corner; clicking Manage Books in the Quick Actions section or on the toolbar at the top; clicking Manage Users in Quick Actions or on the toolbar; or clicking Reports.

The Manage Books page allows the admin to view and manage all book listings. It includes a search bar and a table with columns for Book, Owner, Status, Held By, and Actions. The table lists several books, including 'The Seven Thunders of Evelyn Hoag', 'Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone', 'To Kill a Mockingbird', 'The Great Gatsby', 'Pride and Prejudice', 'Anne of Green Gables', and 'The Fault in Our Stars'. Each row provides options to 'Mark Unavailable', 'Delete', or 'Suspend' the listing.

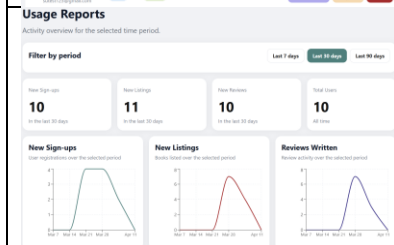
On the Manage Books page, the admin can search for books, filter them by availability status, and toggle availability by making themselves the holder of a book or by returning the book to the owner. Admins cannot set random users as holders; they can only return books or make themselves the holder to flag 'Not_Available'.¹ Admins can also create and delete listings from this page these listings will have the admin as the owner; however, all books can be deleted by the admin.

1 - If owner = holder, then the book is available; if owner != holder, then the book is not available. This logic is reinforced in our schema.

The Manage Users page allows the admin to view and manage all user accounts. It includes a search bar and a table with columns for User, Role, Status, Borrowed, Listings, Reviews, and Actions. The table lists several users, including 'patrick', 'admin', 'admin2', 'user1', 'user2', 'user3', and 'user4'. Each row provides options to 'Suspend', 'Activate', or 'Delete' the user.

The Manage Users page allows the admin to filter users by role, suspend or activate accounts, and delete accounts. On this page, admins can also filter users by their role and search for them by username. Admins cannot create users.

On this page, it is possible to easily see the number of listings a user has and the number of books they are currently borrowing. This gives admins a quick assessment of that user's activity on the platform.



On the Reports page, the administrator will be able to see more details about the platform's state over time. The idea behind this page is to show to the admins the platform's progression within preset time periods: 7, 30, or 90 days.